

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which jobs actually make money?

Period: October 2026 to date. Every job's gross margin: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at \$68 an hour (fully loaded: wages and all on-costs). Pick a type of job and every number, chart and note on the page follows it.

How final is this data?

September 2026 Locked September 2026 is locked (closed 2 Oct 2026). These numbers won't change.

October 2026 Incomplete October 2026 is still in progress: figures to 6 Oct only.

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at \$68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages always include all on-costs: super, payroll tax, workers' compensation insurance and leave.

From gross margin to profit · latest closed month: September

October is still in progress and wages are paid fortnightly, so a part month can't be bridged: this is September, the latest closed month. September's jobs made \$73,107 gross margin (36.1%). Technician time not charged to jobs took \$3,430 and overheads \$59,580, leaving \$10,097 profit before tax (5.0% of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 31.1% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	\$73,107
Technician wages and on-costs	\$54,600
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	\$51,170
Technician time not charged to jobs	\$3,430
Gross profit (the P&L)	\$69,677
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	\$59,580
Profit before tax (the P&L)	\$10,097
Revenue	\$202,337
Gross margin on jobs, %	36.1%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	5.0%
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	31.1%

Type of job: All jobs

Job gross margin, October so far · All jobs

42.8%

target 35.0%

Job gross margin, September · All jobs

36.1%

target 35.0%

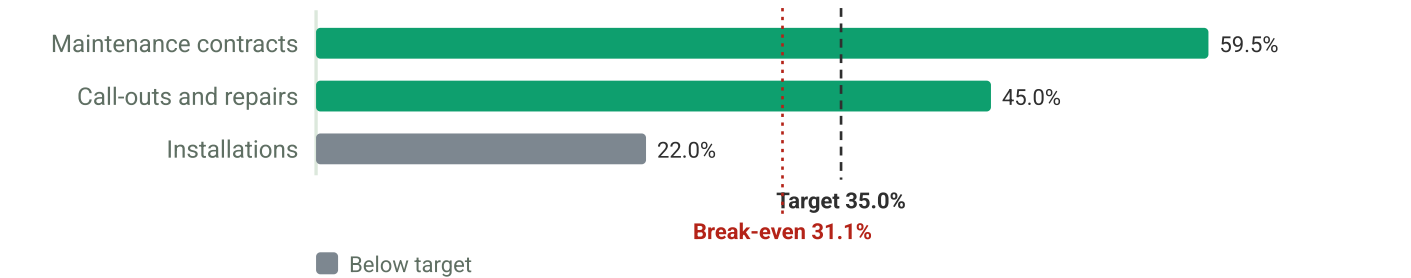
Gross margin jobs need to break even

31.1%

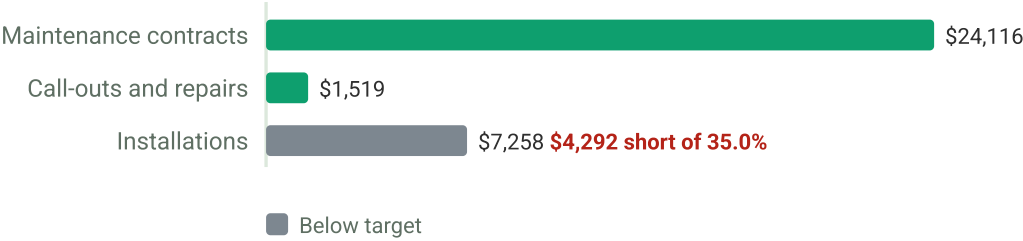
covers overheads and time not charged (September)

Job gross margin by type of job, October 2026 to date

Gross margin %



Gross margin \$



What it shows

In October so far maintenance contracts made a 59.5% job gross margin, installations made a 22.0% job gross margin, call-outs and repairs made a 45.0% job gross margin (technician time at \$68 an hour, wages and all on-costs). Jobs need 31.1% just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 22.0% gross margin, 13.0 points under the 35.0% target: about \$4,292 on \$33,000 of revenue in October so far. It's below the 31.1% needed to cover overheads, too. Maintenance contracts: 59.5% gross margin, 24.5 points over the 35.0% target (\$9,941 ahead on \$40,500 in October so far).

Type of job: Maintenance contracts

Job gross margin, October so far · Maintenance contracts

59.5%

target 35.0%

Job gross margin, September · Maintenance contracts

59.5%

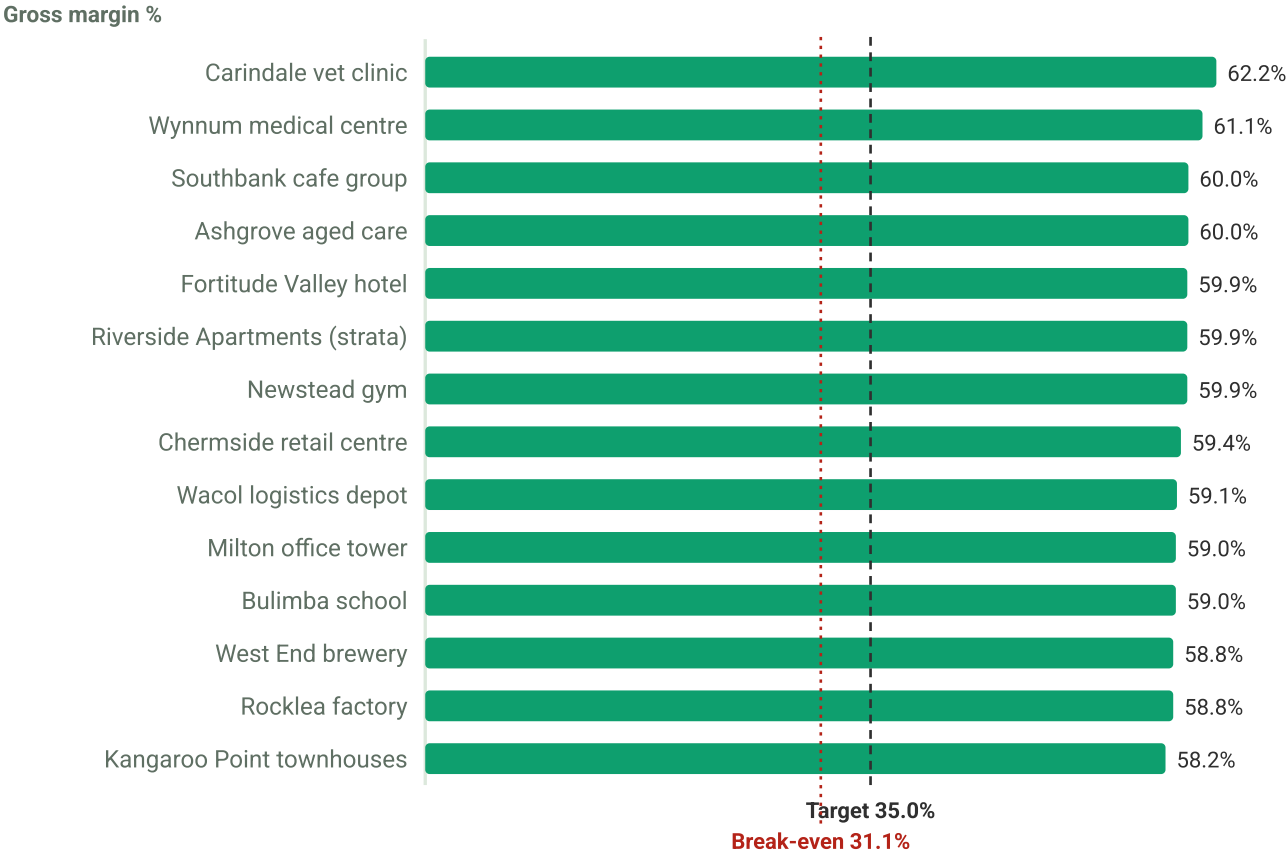
target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even

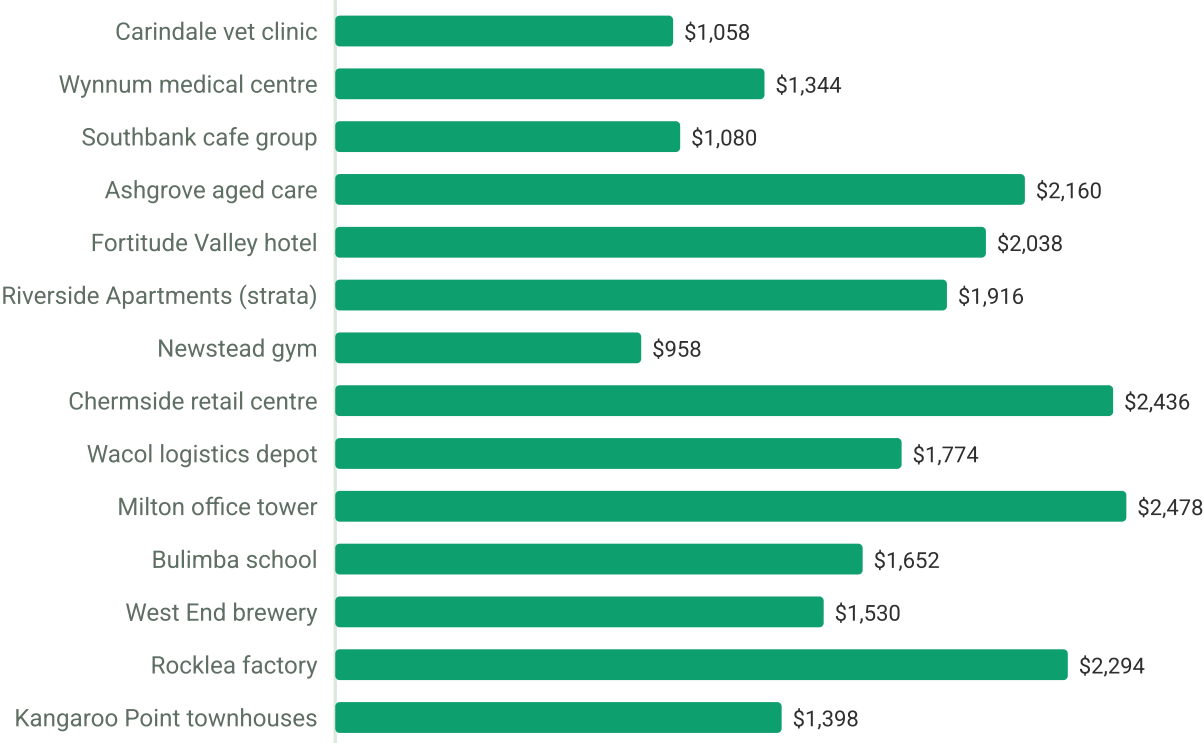
31.1%

covers overheads and time not charged (September)

Job gross margin on each maintenance contract, October 2026 to date



Gross margin \$



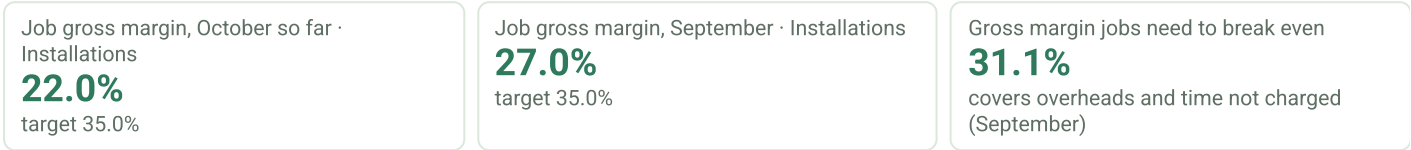
What it shows

All 14 contracts made more than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The thinnest was Kangaroo Point townhouses at 58.2% job gross margin: 14.0 h of technician time on a \$2,400 monthly fee.

What you'd do about it

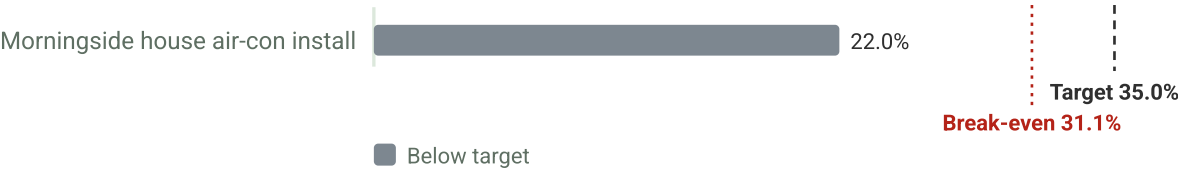
The thinnest, Kangaroo Point townhouses: 58.2% gross margin, 23.3 points over the 35.0% target (\$558 ahead on \$2,400 in October so far). All maintenance contracts: 59.5% gross margin, 24.5 points over the 35.0% target (\$9,941 ahead on \$40,500 in October so far).

Type of job: Installations



Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in October 2026 to date

Gross margin %



Gross margin \$



What it shows

1 of the 1 installation jobs invoiced in October so far made less than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The Morningside house air-con install made a 22.0% job gross margin: 131.5 h of technician time (\$8,942) and \$2,300 of subcontractors on a \$33,000 job. Jobs need 31.1% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

1 installation under the 35.0% target, worth about \$4,292 between them on \$33,000 of revenue. The biggest gap, Morningside house air-con install: 22.0% gross margin, 13.0 points under the 35.0% target: about \$4,292 on \$33,000 of revenue in October so far. It's below the 31.1% needed to cover overheads, too.

Type of job: Call-outs and repairs

Job gross margin, October so far · Call-outs and repairs

45.0%

target 35.0%

Job gross margin, September · Call-outs and repairs

43.9%

target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even

31.1%

covers overheads and time not charged (September)

Technician time charged, October so far

\$2,465

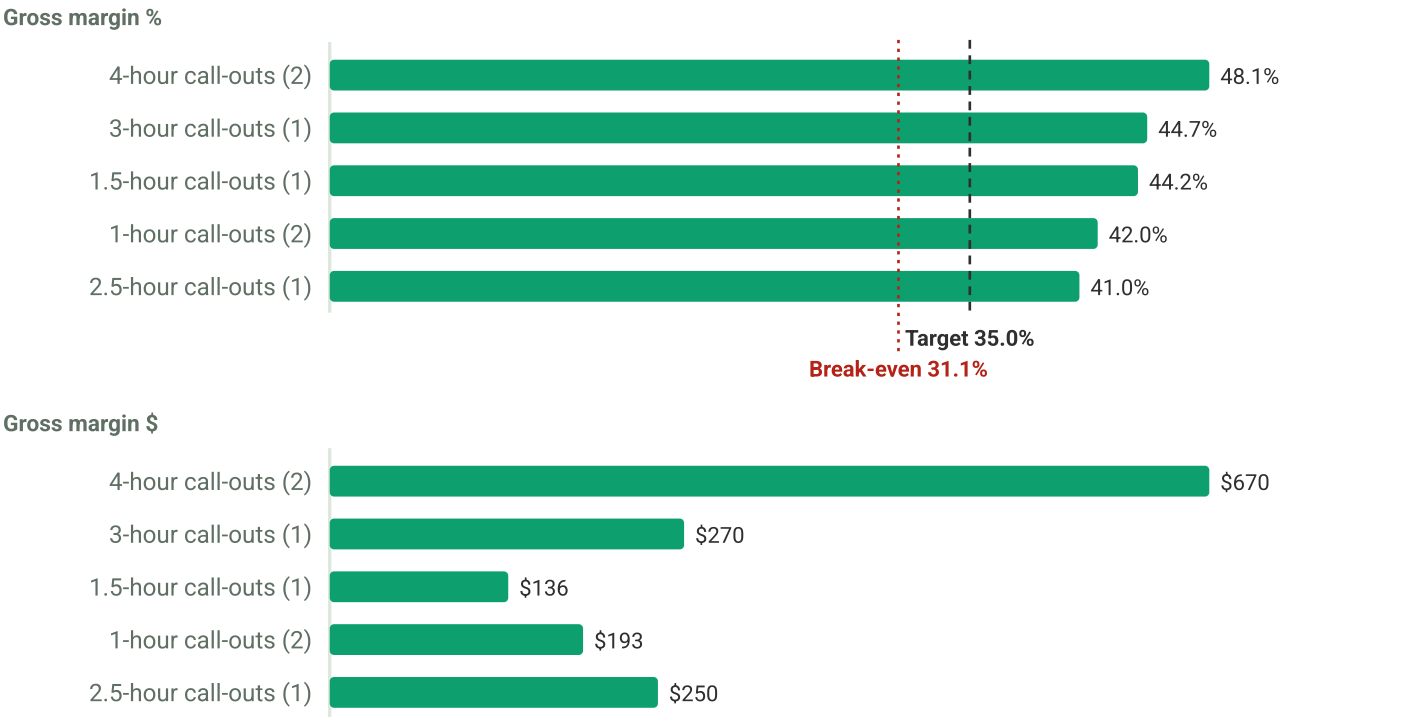
73.0% of call-out revenue

Materials charged, October so far

\$910

\$700 at cost, plus 30%

Job gross margin on call-outs by length, October 2026 to date



What it shows

7 call-outs in October so far billed \$2,465 of technician time and \$910 of materials (\$700 at cost plus 30%), and made a 45.0% job gross margin between them. Gross margins run from 41.0% to 48.1% by length: the hourly rate covers technician time comfortably, so the gross margin mostly moves with how much material goes on the van.

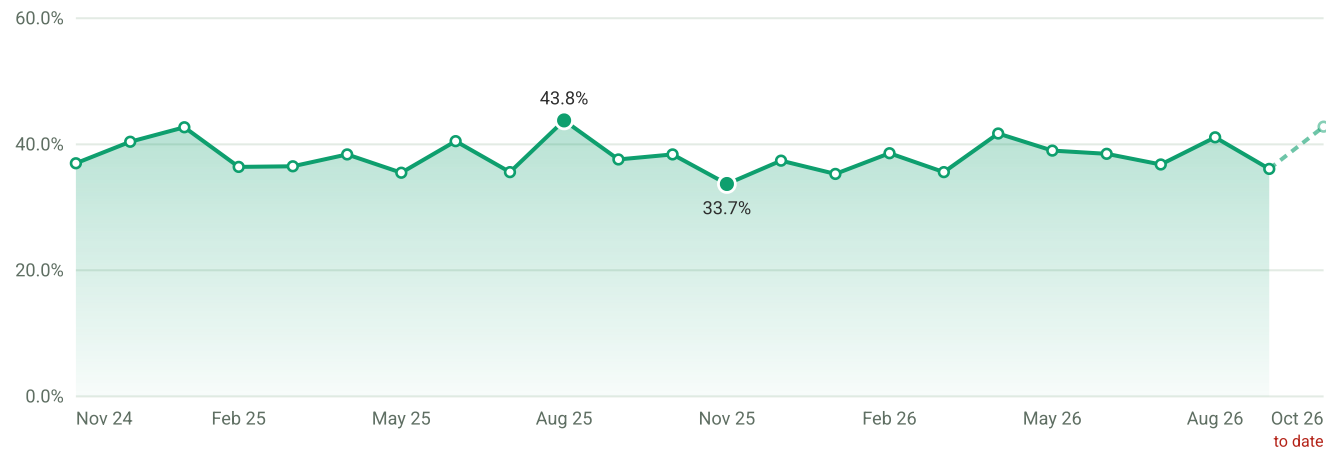
What you'd do about it

All call-outs: 45.0% gross margin, 10.0 points over the 35.0% target (\$338 ahead on \$3,375 in October so far).

Every type of job at once

Job gross margin by month

All · Gross margin %



All · Gross margin \$



Tap a month for its workings. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.